

Letter of Motivation

M.Sc. Applied Entrepreneurship, Winter Semester 2026/27, TH OWL

Dear Members of the Admissions Committee,

My name is Muhammad Usman, a leading entrepreneur in content creation and an experienced software engineer from Pakistan, as well as the founder of Zentron Solutions, a UK-registered company started to address real challenges in the creator economy. I'm applying to the M.Sc. Applied Entrepreneurship at TH OWL to gain the structured business knowledge I need to transform Zentron Solutions from a developing product into a fully operating, revenue-generating business

Academic Background

I completed my BSc in Computer Engineering in 2022 with a CGPA of 3.22/4.00 from the University of Engineering and Technology, Taxila. While my degree provided a solid technical foundation, I realized during my studies that engineering alone could not satisfy my curiosity and drive. I wanted to create something of my own. My passion for solving problems and exploring new ideas led me to pursue entrepreneurship even while still a student.

Building a Team and Discovering the Problem

During this time, I co-founded a content creation venture and built a team of strategists, editors, writers, designers, social media planners, and a sales team. We started by working with other creators on freelance platforms while simultaneously growing our own social channels. Today, the venture collaborates with both small and top-tier international brands and provides services to leading creators on paid campaigns. Yet trust remains the biggest challenge for our sales team, causing friction in collaborations that still rely heavily on emails and chat. This highlighted the core problem we needed to solve.

The Trust Gap in the Creator Economy

Influencer marketing is broken. This isn't just our problem, it is something most creators and brands face.

Brands often pay creators thousands, but sometimes the content never comes. When it does, much of the audience is fake, engagement is low, and the brand sees almost no sales.

Creators face challenges too—AI spam clogs inboxes, and real opportunities get missed, and rates are inconsistent. One brand might pay \$3K, another \$9K for the same work. Nobody really knows what's fair.

My team has been facing this challenge from day one, deal after deal, seeing it from both sides. The truth is, there's no proper system today to run brand-creator collaborations without trust breaking somewhere. And as the creator economy grows, the cost of that broken trust grows too.

Zentron Solutions — What I Am Building

Where others see chaos, my entrepreneurial mindset sees opportunity. That's why I'm building Zentron Solutions—a platform designed to bring trust and fairness to the creator economy. This isn't just an idea; the product is already under development.

Over the past three years, I've built the technical skills to make a product like this a reality. At Pak Web House LLP as a Software Engineer and at Techironed Solutions as a Senior Full Stack Developer, I've built AI products in finance, healthcare, and SaaS—integrating large language models, leading small engineering teams, and collaborating with enterprise clients.

Handling hundreds of deals with international brands have taught me what works and what fails. The solution became clear: standardized digital contracts, transparent pricing, and escrowed payments, all built on a matching system that rewards real performance rather than vanity metrics.

At its core, a matching algorithm will score creators across five dimensions — engagement quality, audience overlap with the brand, content style fit, historical performance, and audience health — rather than follower count alone. Brands get matched with creators who can actually deliver. Creators see opportunities that fit their audience.

On top of that sits the Zentron Score, our pricing system. A creator with 30,000 real, engaged followers can outperform one with 500,000 fake ones. The Score will consider audience size, engagement, niche, platform, and past results. Both sides see a fair price range before negotiating, so the \$3K-versus-\$9K problem disappears.

Once matched, contracts are digital and simple — scope, deliverables, exclusivity, and usage rights all set in one place. Payment is held in escrow and released only when the work is delivered, usually within 72 hours. Six steps take a campaign from brief to paid: brief submitted, creators shortlisted, opt-in, contract signed, campaign run, payment released.

This model rebuilds trust on both sides. Brands know exactly which creator is the best fit and have a smooth workflow from brief to delivery. Creators get a clean payment flow through escrow — no more being ghosted.

Revenue Model

Zentron Solutions will earn revenue through three streams, all aligned with delivery:

- 8% commission per campaign — the primary stream. Pay-per-success. Zero upfront fees for either side.
- \$600/month Scale plan — for brands running four or more campaigns monthly. Reduced 3% commission, dedicated success manager, priority access.
- Value-add services — strategy, brief writing, performance reports, and featured placements, sold à la carte.

The platform will be free to join for both sides. A referral program will give 10% off the first collaboration when a brand or creator refers another. We only earn when campaigns actually go live, our incentives are aligned with both sides from day one.

Implementing the Plan Through the Programme

After comparing entrepreneurship programmes in Germany, the Netherlands, and the UK, I found that TH OWL's M.Sc. Applied Entrepreneurship is uniquely suited for founders running their own start-ups — one mandatory in-person day per week, with the rest delivered digitally. This fits my situation perfectly: Zentron Solutions is already incorporated, my team is operating, and I intend to keep both moving throughout the programme.

I've mapped the next 24 months to align product execution with the curriculum. In the first phase, while taking Customer Development and Lean Start-Up, I'll finish the MVP and run structured discovery interviews with UK brands and creators, testing every assumption before go-to-market spend.

In the second phase, alongside Business Modelling and Prototyping, the MVP moves to private beta with a controlled cohort. Running the first ten campaigns will validate the 8% commission, Zentron Score, and 72-hour payment promise, with feedback from Innovation Campus Lemgo and the OWL founder network.

In the third phase, with Go-to-Market Strategy and Sales modules, I'll scale beta to public launch and prepare a pre-seed round. The UK market comes first, while CIIT and OWL networks help reach European brands and investors. The goal is to graduate with Zentron at break-even or a closed pre-seed — ideally both.

The plan isn't rigid; Lean Start-Up teaches that data will guide changes. My commitment is to use each semester as a forcing function so every module drives concrete progress in the company.

Why Germany

Germany itself is a deliberate choice. It has the strongest start-up ecosystem in continental Europe, a serious engineering culture, and publicly funded universities that respect bootstrapping founders. With Zentron Solutions already registered in the UK, studying in Germany places me in the right corridor of Europe to operate across both ecosystems. Learning German alongside my studies is a long-term investment in access to the European creator and SME market.

Go-to-Market Plan

I'm initially targeting UK-based brands and creators. Registering Zentron as a UK Limited company gives immediate credibility, access to Stripe, Wise, and Revolut Business, allows payments in GBP, USD, EUR, and AED, and ensures contracts are under English commercial law — the global standard for escrow and cross-border agreements. A Pakistan registration wouldn't offer this as cleanly. The UK is also ideal for raising a pre-seed round.

The UK creator economy alone is worth over £18 billion, driven by D2C brands, AI tools, and agencies running multiple campaigns monthly. Once the workflow is proven, we'll expand to continental Europe through the OWL alumni network, then to the Middle East. Globally, the

creator economy is projected to reach USD 480 billion by 2027, growing at 22% CAGR — faster than e-commerce or fintech.

Closing

I may not come from a business school background, but I'm ready to work harder than anyone to close that gap. What I bring is a company already incorporated, a product in development, a functioning team, three years of shipping commercial software, and lived experience of the trust challenges in the creator economy.

My undergraduate years, creator work, software career, and early steps with Zentron Solutions have taught me one thing: I don't stop until a problem is solved. Through TH OWL, I aim to use every semester to turn Zentron Solutions from an idea into a fully operating, successful business while contributing to and learning from the founder community.

Warm regards,

Muhammad Usman

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